



A Level • Cambridge (CIE) • Chemistry

43 mins 23 questions

Multiple Choice Practice

Topical Practice MCQ

18. Carboxylic acids and derivatives

Carefully selected past paper questions by topic.

37 P is a carboxylic acid with molecular formula $C_5H_{10}O_2$.

Carboxylic acid P reacts with an excess of $LiAlH_4$ to form compound Q.

Which pairs of molecules could be carboxylic acid P and compound Q?

	carboxylic acid P	compound Q
1	$CH_3(CH_2)_3COOH$	$CH_3(CH_2)_3OH$
2	$CH_3(CH_2)_3COOH$	$CH_3(CH_2)_3CHO$
3	$(CH_3)_3CCOOH$	$(CH_3)_3CCH_2OH$

A 1 and 2

B 1 and 3

C 2 and 3

D 3 only

- 35** Which substance reacts with ethanoic acid to give the organic product with the highest M_r ?
- A** lithium aluminium hydride
 - B** magnesium
 - C** potassium carbonate
 - D** propan-2-ol

37 A sample of propanoic acid of mass 3.70 g reacts with an excess of magnesium.

A second sample of propanoic acid of mass 3.70 g reacts with an excess of sodium.

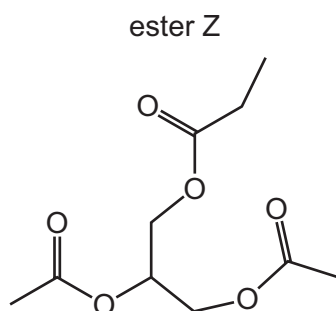
Both reactions go to completion forming a gas.

Which row is correct?

	volume of gas formed with magnesium at s.t.p. / cm ³	volume of gas formed with sodium at s.t.p. / cm ³
A	560	560
B	560	1120
C	1120	560
D	1120	1120

38 Two compounds, X and Y, are mixed and a little concentrated H_2SO_4 is added.

Ester Z is found in the resulting mixture of products.



Which two compounds could be X and Y?

	X	Y
A	$\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$	$\text{CH}(\text{CO}_2\text{H})_3$
B	$\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$	$\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}_2\text{OCOCH}_2\text{CH}_3$
C	$\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{H}$	$\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$
D	$\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{H}$	$\text{CH}_2(\text{OH})\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}_2(\text{OH})$

- 36** Compound Q can be hydrolysed by HCl(aq) . The two products of this hydrolysis have the same empirical formula.

What could Q be?

- A** $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$
- B** $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{H}$
- C** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_3$
- D** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CH(OH)CH(OH)CH}_2\text{CH}_3$

38 How many esters with the molecular formula $\text{C}_5\text{H}_{10}\text{O}_2$ can be made by reacting a primary alcohol with a carboxylic acid?

A 4

B 5

C 6

D 8

- 38 Which compound can be used to make propanoic acid by treatment with a single reagent?
- A $\text{CH}_2=\text{CHCH}_2\text{CH}_3$
 - B $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CN}$
 - C $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CN}$
 - D $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}_3$

- 29** Compound Q can be hydrolysed by HCl(aq) . The two products of this hydrolysis have the same empirical formula.

What could Q be?

- A** $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$
- B** $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{H}$
- C** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_3$
- D** $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CH(OH)CH(OH)CH}_2\text{CH}_3$

- 29 Which compound can be used to make propanoic acid by treatment with a single reagent?
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 - B $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CN}$
 - C $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CN}$
 - D $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CH}_3$

- 28** A carboxylic acid, P, has no possible chain isomers. It reacts with an alcohol, Q, that has only one positional isomer.

What could be the ester formed from a reaction between P and Q?

- A** butyl propanoate
- B** ethyl butanoate
- C** pentyl ethanoate
- D** propyl pentanoate

23 Carboxylic acids may be prepared by several different methods.

In which reaction would propanoic acid be formed?

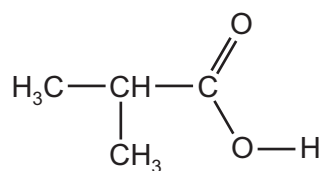
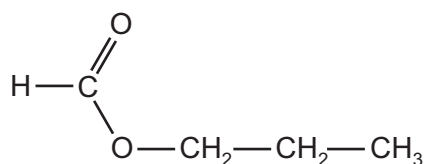
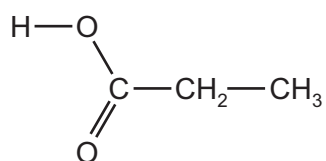
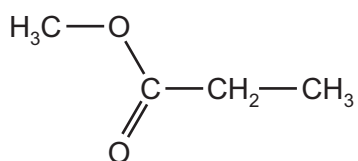
- A** adding ammonium propanoate to dilute sulfuric acid
- B** heating ethyl propanoate with aqueous sodium hydroxide
- C** heating propan-2-ol with acidified potassium manganate(VII) under reflux
- D** heating propyl ethanoate with dilute sulfuric acid

- 26 Ethane-1,2-diol, $\text{HOCH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{OH}$, reacts with an excess of ethanoic acid, $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{H}$, in the presence of an acid catalyst. A compound is formed with the molecular formula $\text{C}_6\text{H}_{10}\text{O}_4$.

What is the structure of this compound?

- A $\text{CH}_3\text{OCOCH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_3$
- B $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_3$
- C $\text{CH}_3\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{OCOCH}_3$
- D $\text{HOCH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{COCH}_2\text{OCOCH}_3$

- 29 How many of the compounds shown will react with aqueous sodium hydroxide to form the sodium salt of a carboxylic acid?



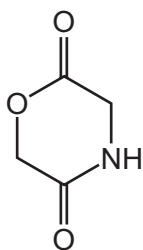
A 1

B 2

C 3

D 4

21 The cyclic compound M is heated with dilute hydrochloric acid.



compound M

What are the products of the reaction?

- A $\text{HOCH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{H}$ and $\text{H}_2\text{NCH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{H}$
- B $\text{HO}_2\text{CCH}_2\text{OH}$ and $\text{HO}_2\text{CCH}_2\text{NH}_3^+$
- C $\text{H}_2\text{NCOCH}_2\text{OH}$ and HOCH_2CHO
- D $\text{HOCH}_2\text{CONH}_3^+$ and HOCH_2CHO

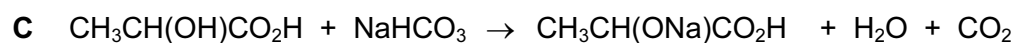
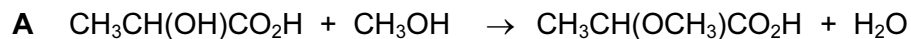
20 Diesters can be made from diacids such as propane-1,3-dioic acid, $\text{HO}_2\text{CCH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{H}$.

Which combination of reactants would form the diester $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}_2\text{OCOCH}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CO}_2\text{CH}_2\text{CH}_3$?

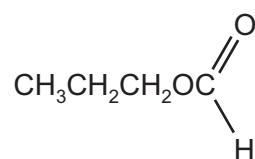
- A butane-1,4-dioic acid and ethanol
- B ethanedioic acid and propan-1-ol
- C ethanedioic acid, ethanol and butan-1-ol
- D propane-1,3-dioic acid, ethanol and propan-1-ol

21 Lactic acid (2-hydroxypropanoic acid), $\text{CH}_3\text{CH}(\text{OH})\text{CO}_2\text{H}$, is found in sour milk.

Which reaction could occur with lactic acid?



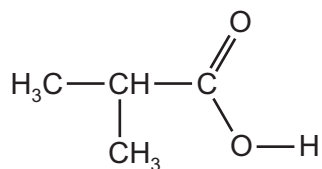
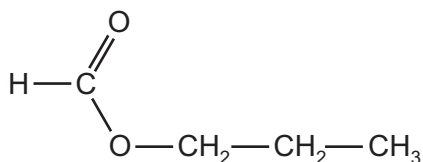
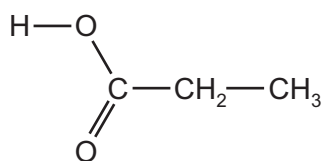
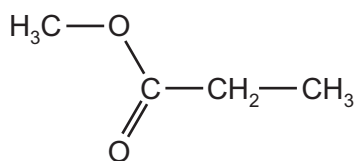
28 The structural formula of a compound **X** is shown below.



What is the name of compound **X** and how does its boiling point compare with that of butanoic acid?

	name of X	boiling point of X
A	methyl propanoate	higher
B	methyl propanoate	lower
C	propyl methanoate	higher
D	propyl methanoate	lower

- 29 How many of the compounds shown will react with aqueous sodium hydroxide to form the sodium salt of a carboxylic acid?



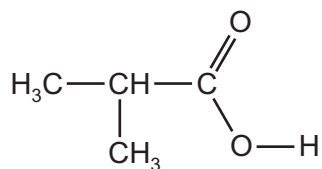
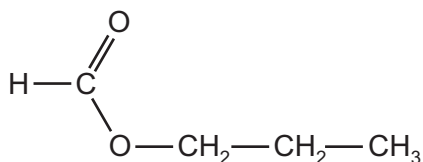
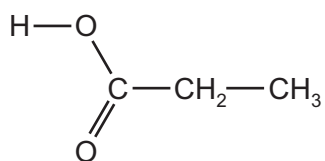
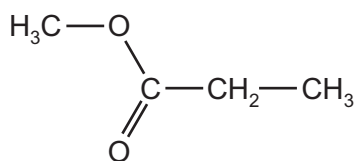
A 1

B 2

C 3

D 4

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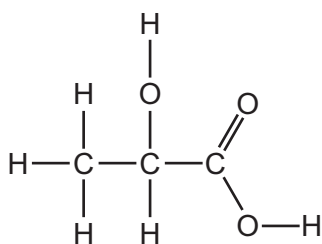
A 1

B 2

C 3

D 4

26 Lactic acid occurs naturally, for example in sour milk.

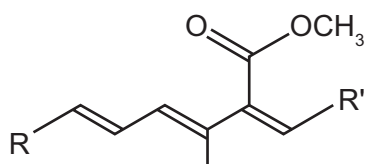


lactic acid

What is a property of lactic acid?

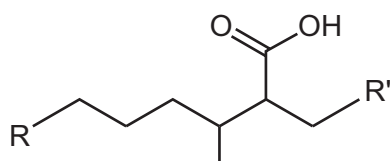
- A** It decolourises aqueous bromine rapidly.
- B** It is insoluble in water.
- C** It reduces Fehling's reagent.
- D** Two molecules react with each other in the presence of a strong acid.

27 Part of the structure of strobilurin, a fungicide, is shown. R and R' are inert groups.

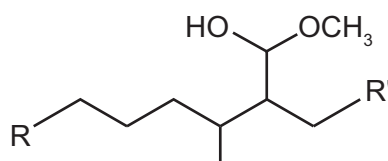


If strobilurin is first warmed with aqueous sulfuric acid, and its product then treated with hydrogen in the presence of a palladium catalyst, what could be the structure of the final product?

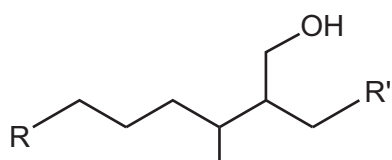
A



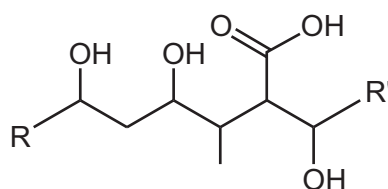
B



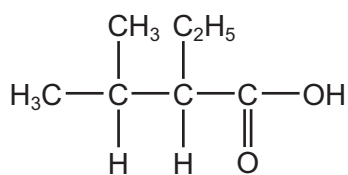
C



D

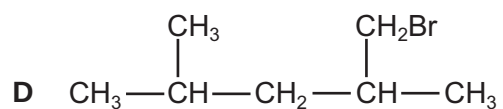
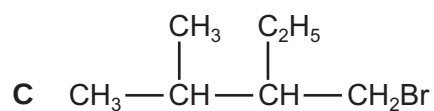
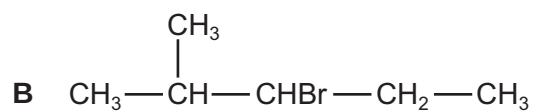
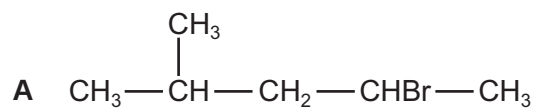


- 29 The characteristic odour of rum is attributed to the compound 2-ethyl-3-methylbutanoic acid.

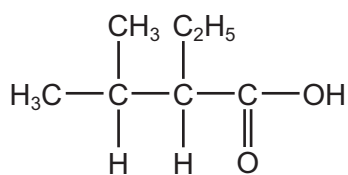


2-ethyl-3-methylbutanoic acid

Which compound will produce 2-ethyl-3-methylbutanoic acid by heating under reflux with alcoholic sodium cyanide and subsequent acid hydrolysis of the reaction product?

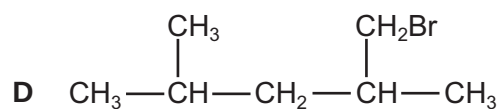
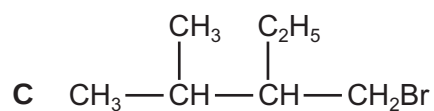
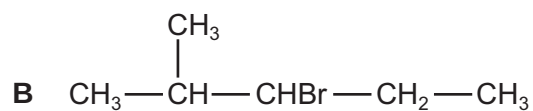
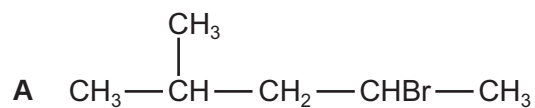


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2-ethyl-3-methylbutanoic acid

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Answer Key

No.	Paper	Topic	Answer
1	9701_s24_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
2	9701_s24_qp_13	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
3	9701_w24_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
4	9701_s23_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	C
5	9701_s23_qp_13	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
6	9701_w23_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	C
7	9701_s22_qp_13	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
8	9701_w19_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
9	9701_w18_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
10	9701_s17_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
11	9701_s17_qp_13	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
12	9701_w16_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	C
13	9701_w16_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
14	9701_s15_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
15	9701_s14_qp_13	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
16	9701_s13_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
17	9701_s13_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
18	9701_w13_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
19	9701_w13_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
20	9701_w10_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	D
21	9701_w10_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	A
22	9701_w09_qp_11	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B
23	9701_w09_qp_12	18. Carboxylic acids and derivative...	B